

Lab - Creating a Virtual Install of Windows 10 Pro – 2024

Overview

That's a brief overview of creating a virtual installation of Windows 10 Pro using VirtualBox for 2024. Microsoft keeps changing the rules for obtaining a copy of Windows 10 Pro. Getting a legal copy of Windows 10 Pro from M\$ requires yet another creative workaround.

Why Windows 10 Pro? The only legal version of Windows 10 that can be downloaded as an eval is Windows 10 Enterprise. This requires the product to be joined to an organization, domain, or Microsoft account.

Windows 10 Pro can still be installed as a stand-alone workstation.

Lab Requirements

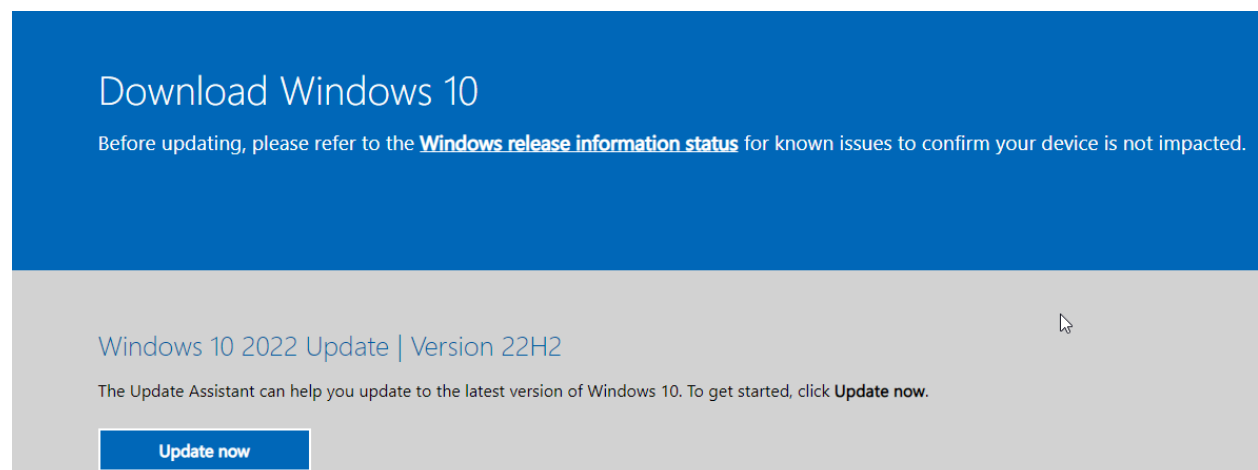
- One Installation of VirtualBox with the extension pack
- One install of Chrome Browser
- One download of Windows 10 Mult-Edition ISO

Spoofing Your Browser to Get Access to Windows 10 Pro

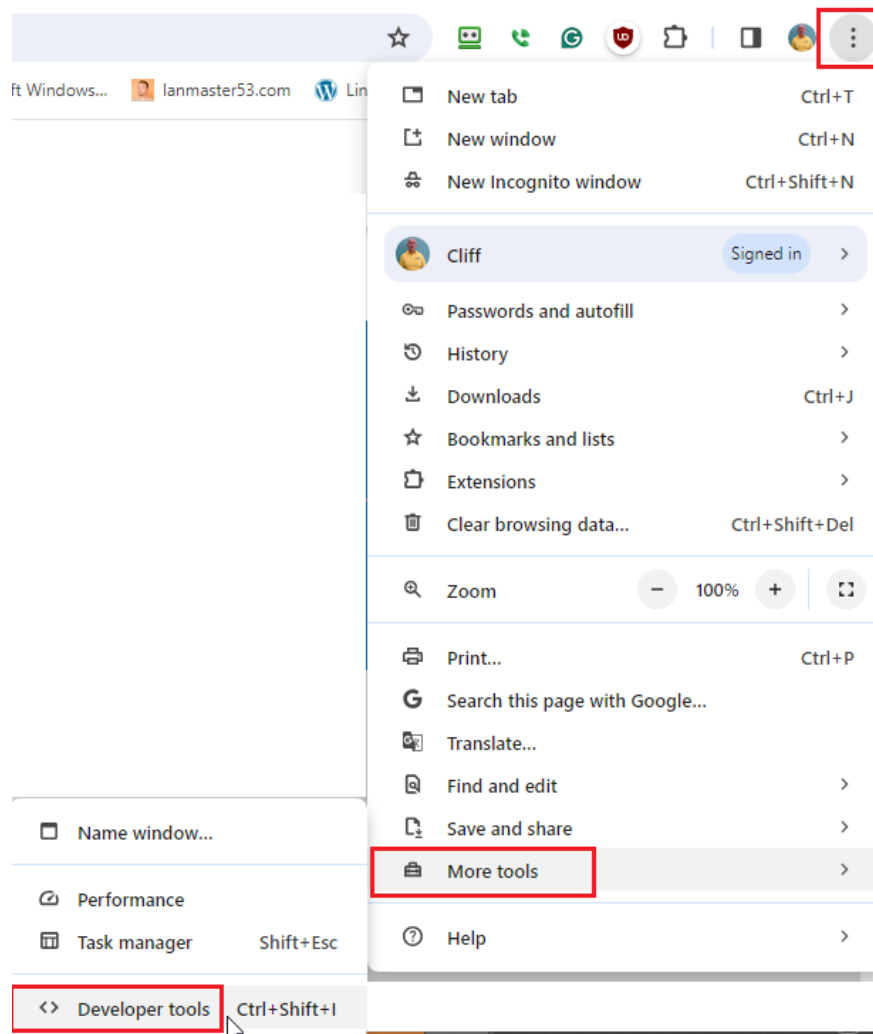
Open a browser and go to the Windows 10 ISO download page.

<https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/software-download/windows10>

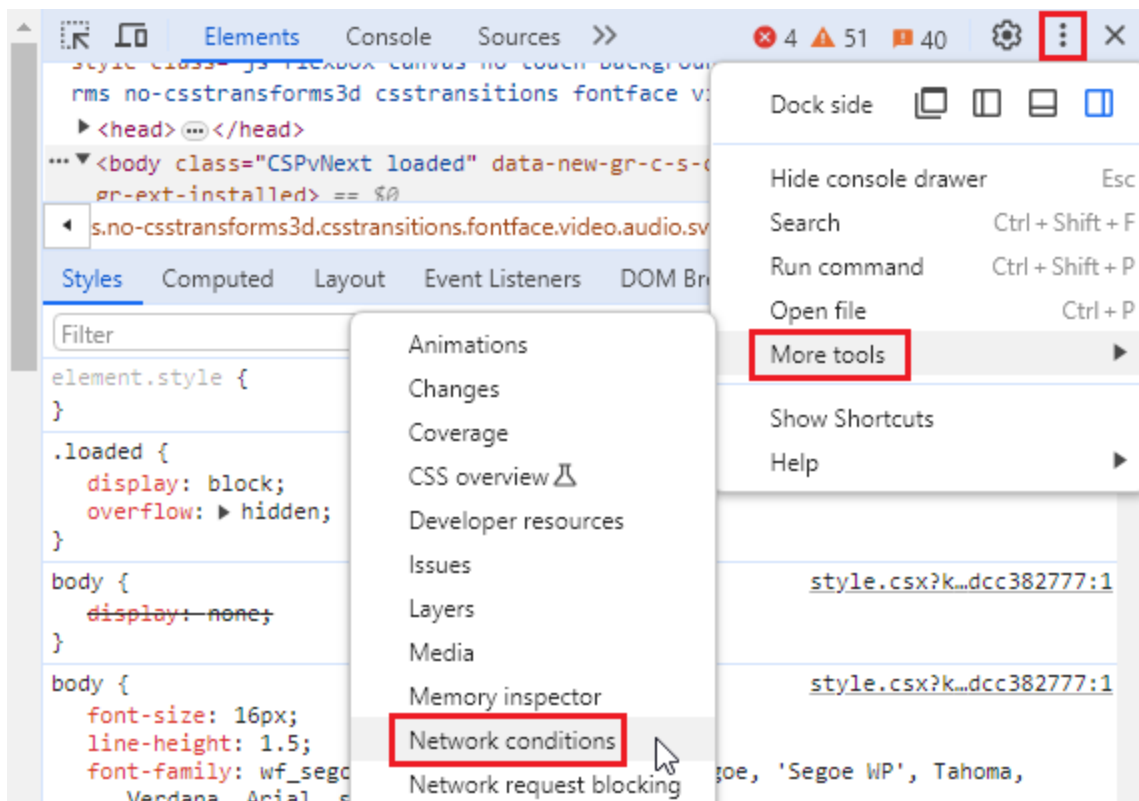
I cannot be responsible for every time Microsoft changes the download location for its products. If the link goes bad, open a browser and search for a new download location.



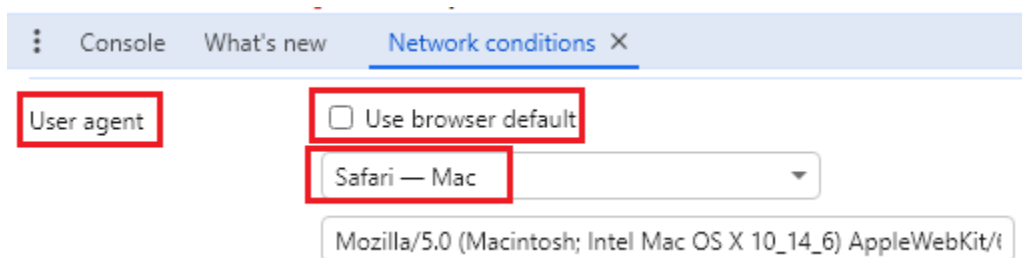
Once you have the download page for Windows 10, navigate to the top right corner of your Chrome browser and click on the three dots. Scroll down until you come to more tools, and on the last content menu, click on the link for Developer Tools.



With the developer tools open, navigate again to the top right and, once again, click on the three dots. Scroll and click on More Tools. On the last context menu, click on Network Conditions.



Scroll down to the bottom windowpane. Find the User Agent and uncheck the box that is labeled, **Use browser default**. Accept the default for Safari-Mac.



Leave the developer tools open, place your pointer on the download page, click one time, and refresh the page (F5).

Note that the page changes download options.

Download Windows 10 Disc Image (ISO File)

Before updating, please refer to the **Windows release information status** for known issues to confirm your device is not impacted.

You can now download the Windows 10 Multi-Version edition and select which version to install. Confirm your choice.

Windows 10 2023 Update | Version 22H2

Select edition

Windows 10 editions below are valid for both Windows 10 Home and Windows 10 Pro.

Select edition

Select edition

Windows 10 (multi-edition ISO)

Confirm

Confirm your language.

Select the product language

You'll need to choose the same language when you install Windows. To see what language you're currently using, go to **Time and language** in PC settings or **Region** in Control Panel.

English (United States)

Confirm

Download your hardware type.

Downloads

Choose a link below to begin the download. If not sure which one to choose then refer to [FAQ](#).

Windows 10 English

32-bit Download

64-bit Download

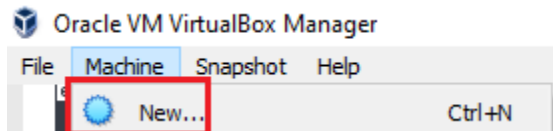
 [Verify your download](#)

Save the download to your favorite location.

File name:	Win10_22H2_English_x64v1.iso
Save as type:	Disc Image File (*.iso)

Create a virtual install of Windows 10 Pro.

Open your VirtualBox management console and from the VirtualBox taskbar,



On the next screen, fill in the information as needed. You will need to point VirtualBox to the download location for your ISO.

✓ Name and Operating System

Name: Windows 10 Pro

Folder: E:\VirtualBox VMs

ISO Image: C:\Users\Clifton Krahenbill\Dropbox\PC (2)\Desktop\Win10_22H2_English_x64v1.iso

Edition: Windows 10 Home (10.0.19041.2965 / x64 / en-US)

Type: Microsoft Windows

Version: Windows 10 (64-bit)

☒ Skip Unattended Installation

> Unattended Install

> Hardware

> Hard Disk

Click finish to create the virtual disk. In the left window pane of your VirtualBox manager, find the virtual disk you just created and click to begin the installation of the operating system.



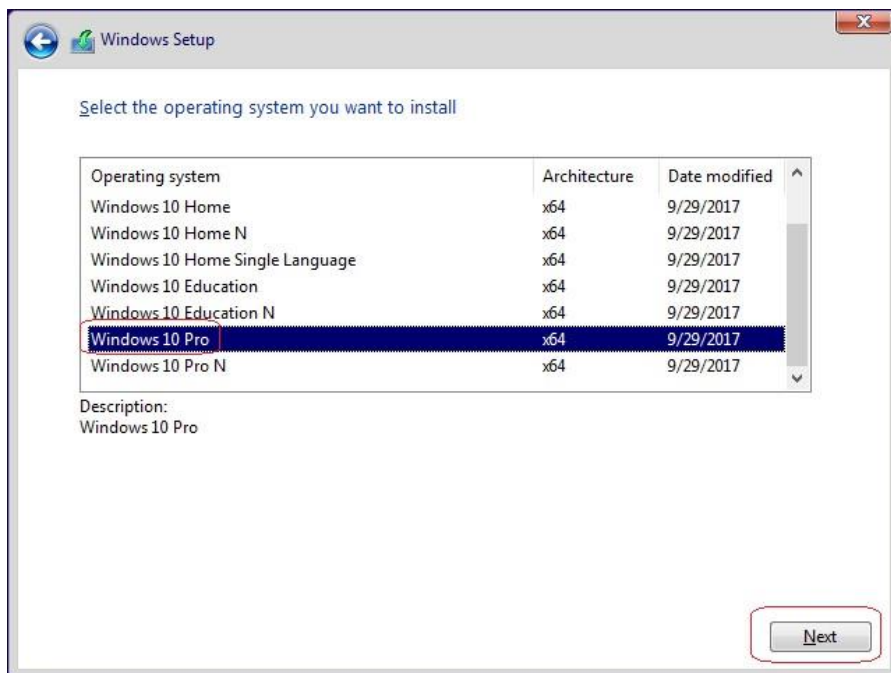
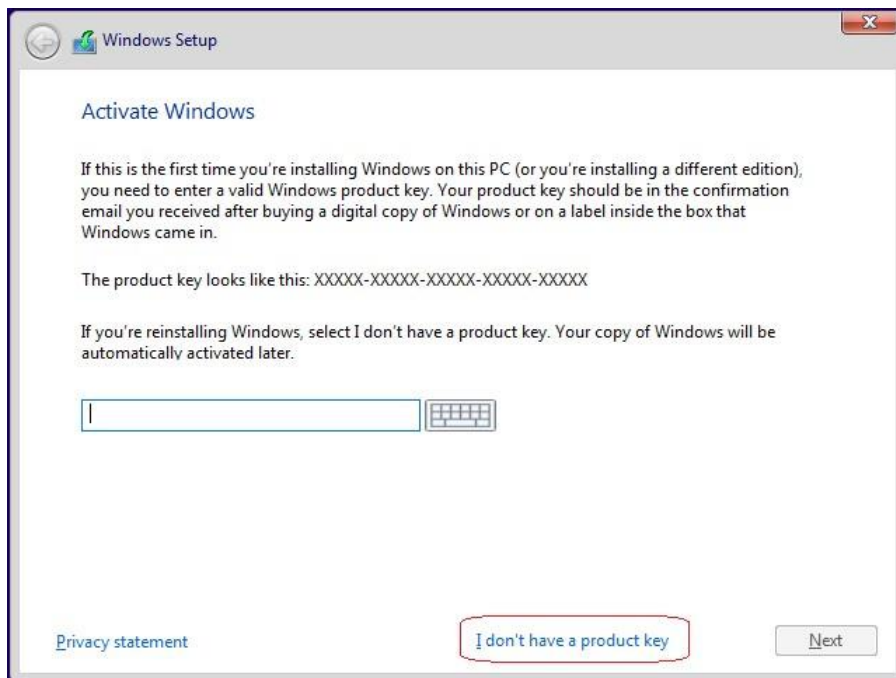
The Windows 10 installation starts. Click next.



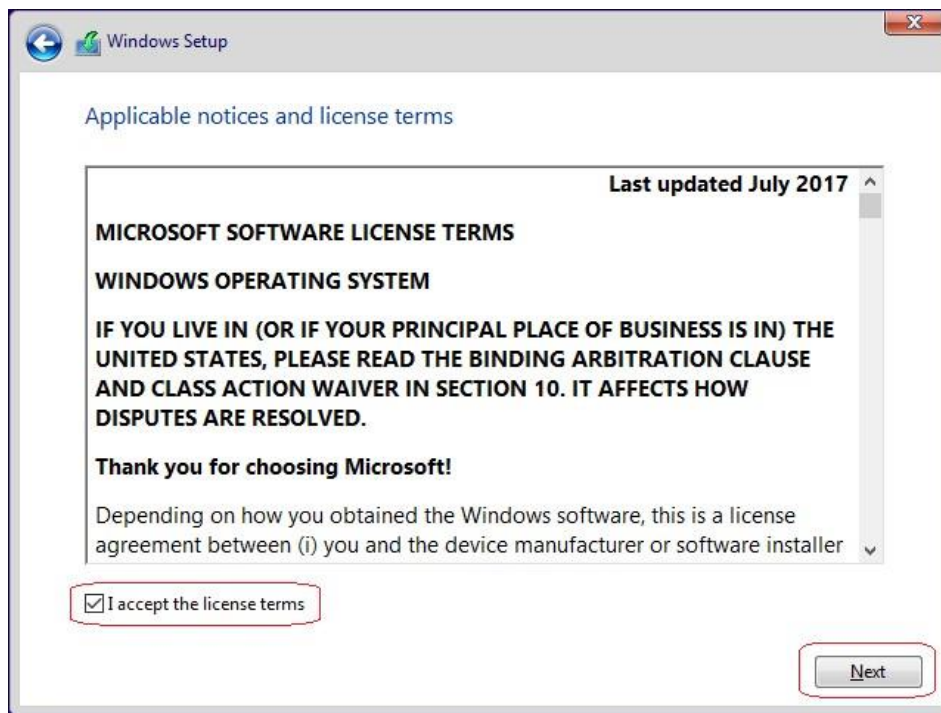
On the next windows, click on the Install now button.



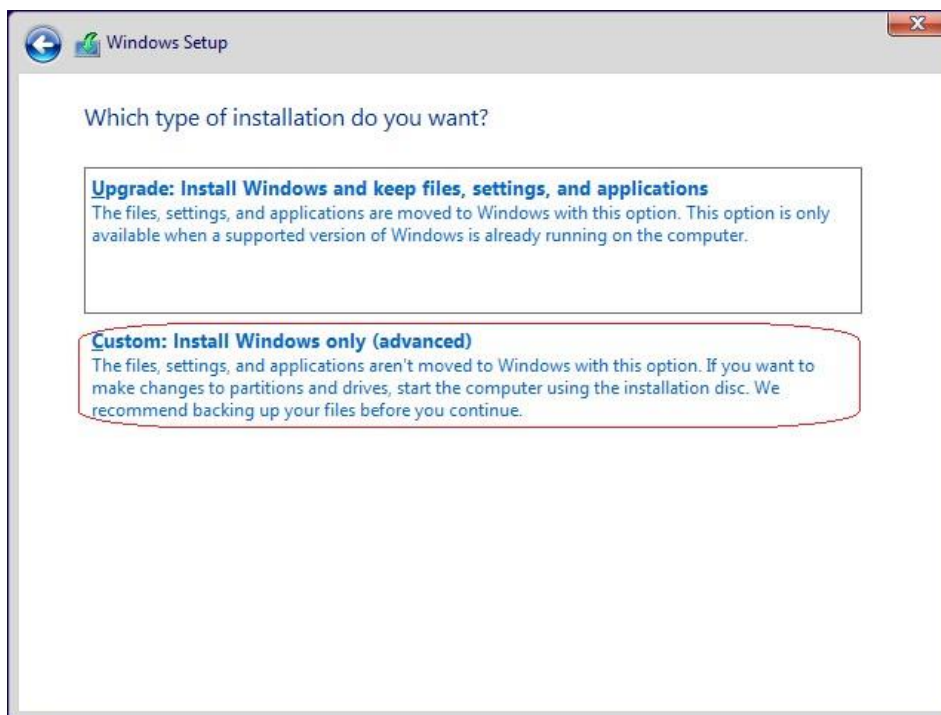
On the Activate Windows screen, you can click the link entitled, "I do not have a product key."



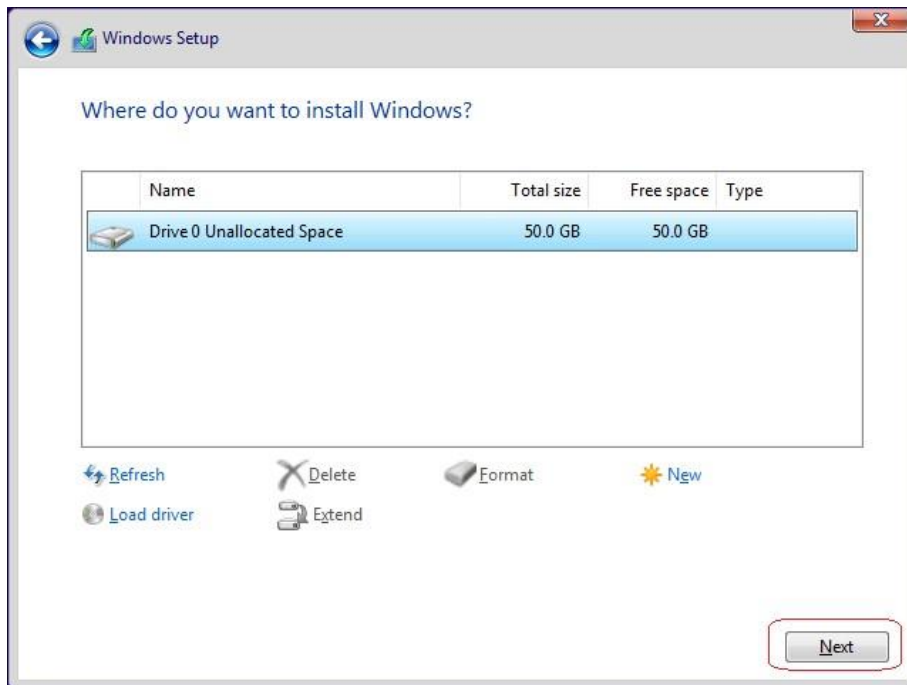
On the license screen, check the to accept the terms. Click Next.



On the next screen click on the option marked Custom.



On the next Window, you only need to click on the Next button.

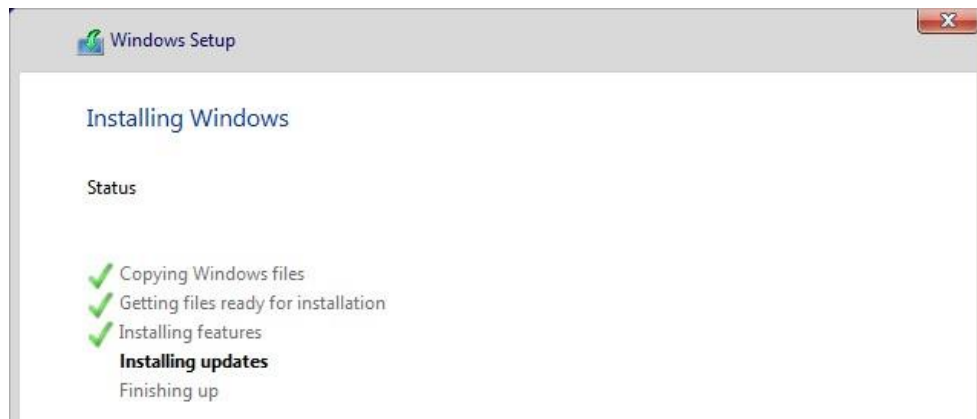


The installation begins.

Allow the install to proceed without any interruption.



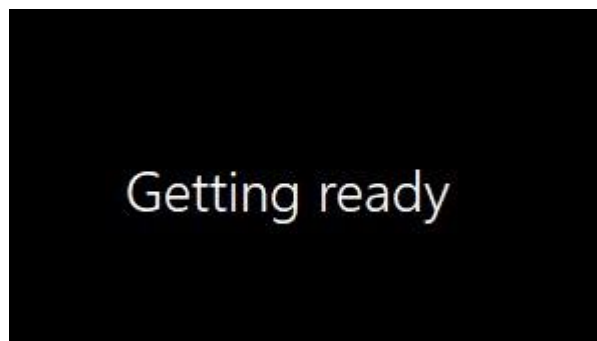
This step will take some time to complete; relax, go for a walk, or watch some TV, but allow the installation to complete. The Easy Install feature of VMWare will do all the work.



Windows will restart



Windows will prepare for your first use and prepare your desktop.



Windows will restart one more time.... wait for the desktop or log in.

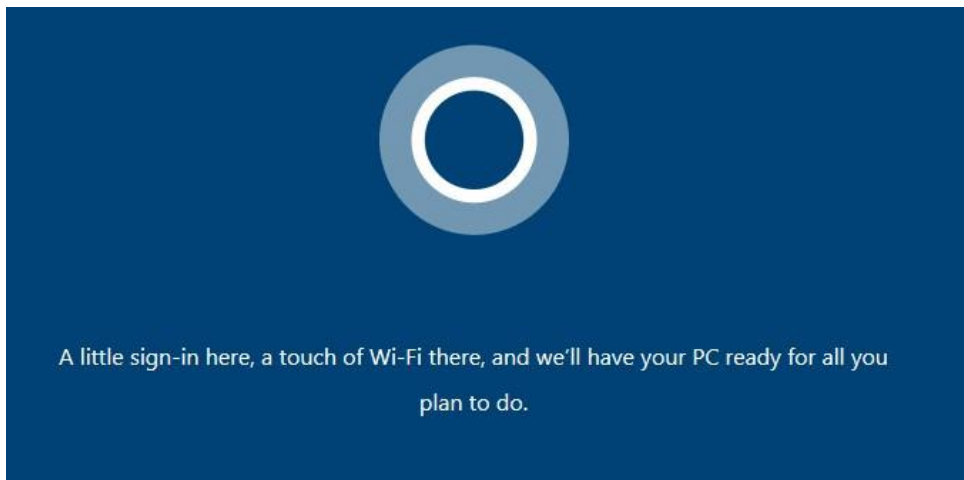


Windows 10 continues with the building of the user's profile.



Windows 10 will restart one more time.

The Windows 10 Interactive menu begins.



Set your region and click yes.

Let's start with region. Is this right?

U.S. Minor Outlying Islands
U.S. Virgin Islands
Uganda
Ukraine
United Arab Emirates
United Kingdom
United States

Select your keyboard layout and click yes.

Is this the right keyboard layout?

US

Canadian Multilingual Standard
English (India)
Irish
Scottish Gaelic
United Kingdom
United States-Dvorak

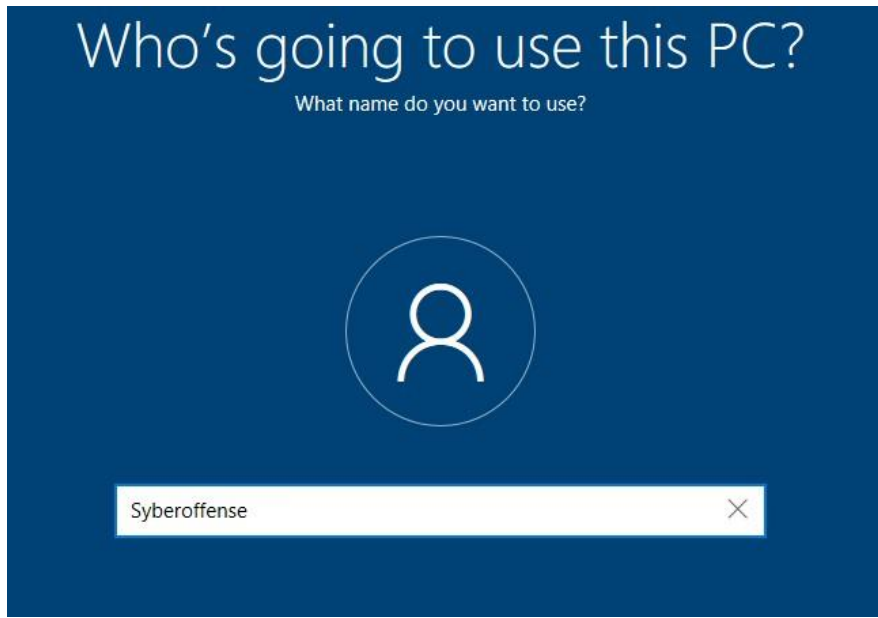
Want to add a second keyboard? Click skip.

Want to add a second keyboard layout?

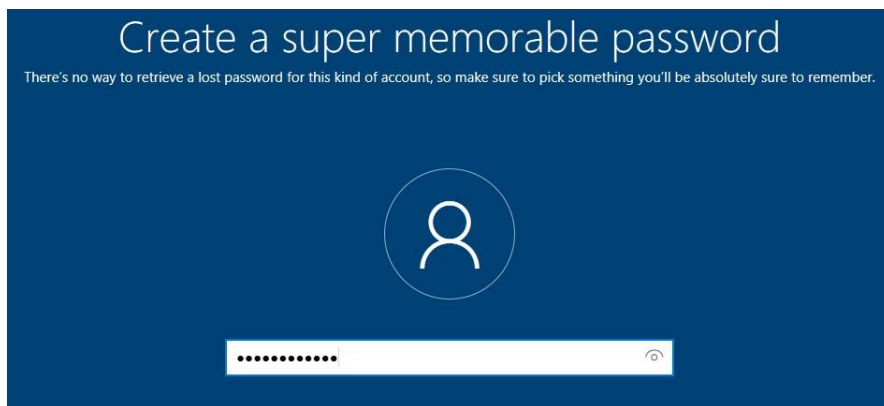
You can connect to a network or select skip for now. Select, Skip for now.



Select your username and then click next.



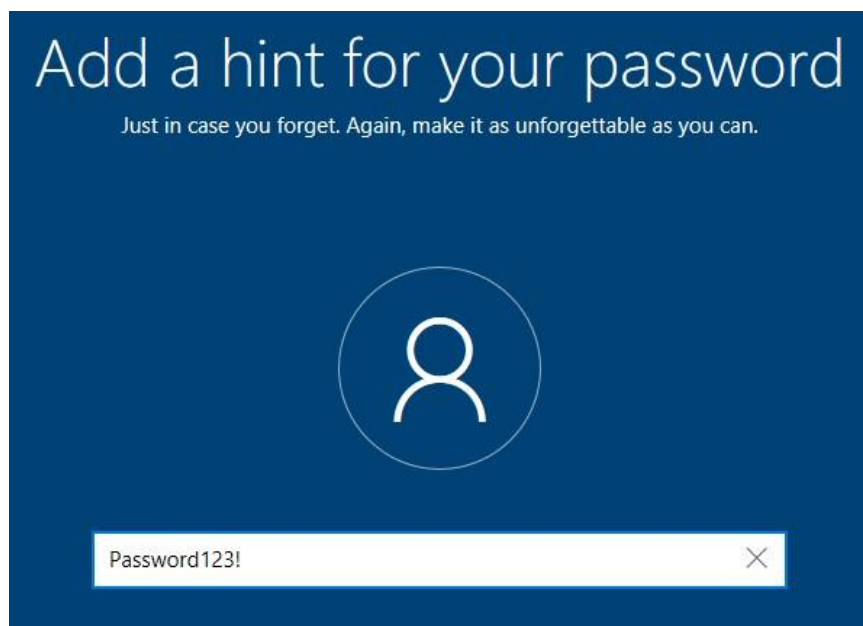
Type in a password. Click Next.



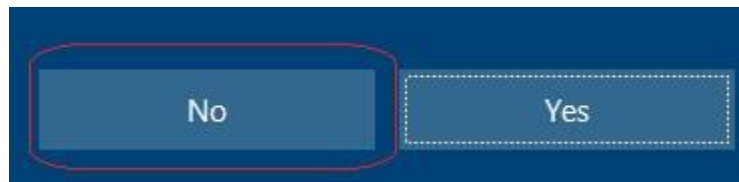
Confirm your password.



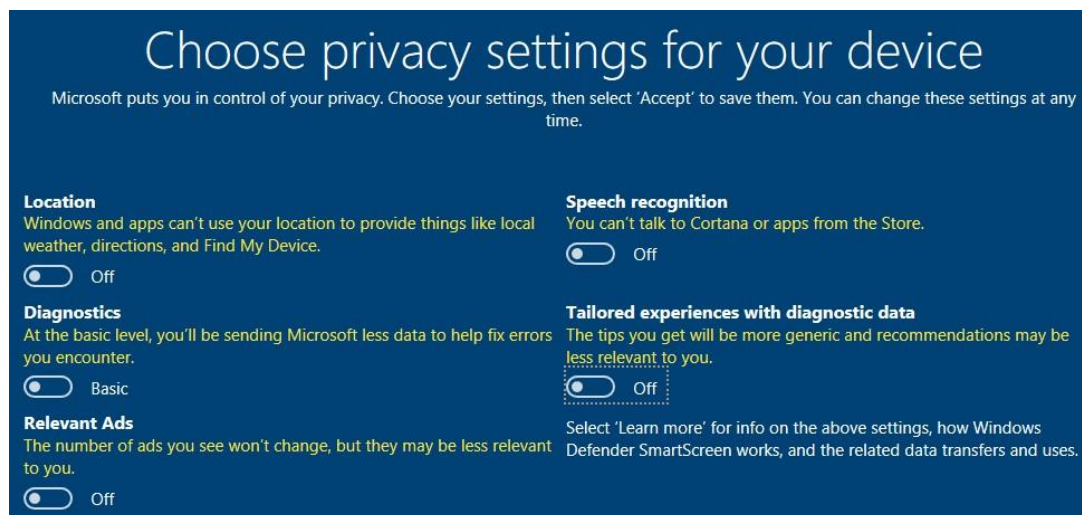
Add a hint for your password. Click next.



Disable Cortana...or not.



Select your privacy settings. Click accept.



At last!



Once the desktop appears, you may be asked if you want Windows 10 to be discoverable by other devices. I always choose no, but you free to select yes.



Your Windows 10 client is ready for prime time. In Section 3, we will optimize and add your Windows 10 client to your new Server 2012 or 2016 domain.

End of the lab!